

Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

Education

University of Groningen | Groningen, the Netherlands Sep 2023 – present

Experimental Psychology | *PhD Candidate*

Advisors: Prof. Dr. Elkan G. Akyürek & Dr. Wouter Kruijne

Leibniz Research Institute for Working Environment and Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

Human Factors | Dortmund, Germany

Ergonomics Department | *Visiting Researcher*

Advisor: Dr. Daniel Schneider

Sabancı University | Istanbul, Turkey Sep 2020 – June 2023

Cognitive Psychology MSc, GPA: 3.95/4.0

Advisor: Dr. Eren Günseli

MEF University | Istanbul, Turkey Oct 2016 – June 2020

Psychology BA, GPA: 3.77/4.0

Publications (and Preprints)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. (2026, preprint). Mentally transformed representations in memory are linked to their originals.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.10.750562>

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. (2026, preprint). Diffuse predictions stabilize and reshape the neural code during working memory encoding. *bioRxiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.02.23.707359>

Ataseven, N., Algin, E., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Todorova, L., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2026). Memory reactivation levels remain unaffected by anticipated interference. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2625>

Yılmaz, Y., **Ataseven, N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E., & Günseli, E. (2026). Passive but accessible: Studied information is not actively stored in working memory, yet attended regardless of anticipated load. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 38(9), 1721–1734.

<https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2619>

Ataseven, N., Ünver, N., & Günseli, E. (2023). How does divided attention hinder different stages of episodic memory retrieval?. *Current Research in Behavioral Sciences*, 100139.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.crbeha.2023.100139>

Yücel, D., **Ataseven, N.**, Todorova, L., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2023, preprint). Increased reliance on long-term memory when anticipating attentional guidance. *PsyArXiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/cs9qa>

Peker, M., Atar, H. Ö., & **Ataseven, N.** (2017). A review on interpersonal distance: Culture, gender, power, and directions for future research. *The British Psychological Society North East Branch Bulletin*, 6, 8-17.

Ongoing Research

Writing Stage

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven N.**, Kruijne W., Akyürek E. G., & Schneider, D. Key features of motor code formation in working memory.

Data Analysis Stage

Ataseven N., Brady, T. F., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. Bidirectional relationship between statistical regularity learning and attention.

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E. G., & Schneider, D. Representational shift from sensory input to action plans in working memory.

Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. Anticipation of attentional demands modulates task performance through allocation of spatial attention.

Ataseven, N., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. How does interference influence prioritised and unprioritised information?

Invited Talks

University of Cambridge, Talk at the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Online, 2026
(To be presented)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Neural representations underlying mental and physical transformation

Bern University of Applied Sciences Online, 2026

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Mentally rotated representations are linked to their originals. Video recording:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/16krOS3_InpM-JKMLYKa4v7DKGxok7C8L/view?usp=sharing

University of Würzburg Online, 2024

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Prior information shapes representations in visual working memory.

Conference Presentations

WM Symposium Online, 2026

Blitz Talk

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Mental rotation products are bound to their initially encoded originals: maintained together and dropped together. Program link:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1SRVnI9MgzQ_AyvkeRkNyeJOrlQ2xJggG/view

Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference Vancouver, Canada, 2026

Poster

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Diffuse predictions reshape WM representations at encoding

NVP Winter Conference Egmond aan Zee, the Netherlands, 2025

Symposium Talk (Computational and neural mechanisms of prediction)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Prior information about upcoming stimulus influences stimulus representation at encoding

WM Symposium Online, 2025

Blitz Talk

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Revealing the effect of prior information on neural representations in WM. Program link:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ZfB2mZNE1r9YZNc87iPKY5DB_4iAkgk/view

Vision Sciences Society Florida, USA, 2025

Poster

Ataseven N., Özdemir Ş., Schneider D., Kruijne W., & Akyurek E. G. Revealing the effect of regularities on representations in visual working memory. Program link:

<https://www.visionsciences.org/presentation/?id=2625>

Working Memory Symposium Online, 2024

Blitz Talk

Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. Attentional allocation to target memories when anticipating distractors. Program link: <https://www.wmsymposium.org/program>

NVP Winter Conference

Egmond aan Zee, the Netherlands, 2023

Poster

Ataseven, N., Kruijne W., & Akyürek E. G. The role of activity-silent working memory in protection against distraction.

European Society for Cognitive Psychology

Porto, Portugal, 2023

Poster

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B, Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. Working memory takes over long-term memory when anticipating perceptual interference.

Working Memory Symposium

Online, 2023

Talk

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B, Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. The effect of anticipated interference, memory load, and long-term memory availability on working memory reactivation.

Program link: <https://www.wmsymposium.org/archive#h.3f29qtpmld52>

Working Memory Symposium

Online, 2022

Talk

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B, Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. Information available in long-term memory is reactivated in working memory regardless of anticipated perceptual interference.

Program link: <https://www.wmsymposium.org/archive#h.r5footh4clbl>

Teaching Experience

University of Groningen

Sep 2023 - present

- Research Practicum
 - Role: Lecturer
 - Responsibilities:
 - Guided and evaluated students as they wrote their first scientific paper.
- Academic Skills
 - Role: Lecturer
 - Gave a year-round course focused on development of academic skills.
 - Guided and evaluated students through oral presentations, essay writing, and a literature review.
- Bachelor Thesis
 - Role: Lecturer/Supervisor
 - Supervised a group of Bachelor's students throughout the thesis-writing process.
- Statistics III
 - Role: Lecturer
 - Responsibilities:
 - Held office hours and supported students with statistical analysis assignments.
 - Graded students' assignments and provided feedback.

Sabancı University

Sep 2020 – Sep 2023

- PSY304: Research Methods and Statistics for Psychology II
 - Role: Teaching Assistant
 - Responsibilities:

Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

- Ran lab sessions helping students with basic statistical analyses using JASP/Jamovi and reporting the results.
- Held office hours and provided feedback on students' weekly exercises.
- PSY316: Attention
 - Role: Teaching Assistant
 - Responsibilities:
 - Held one-to-one meetings with students in preparation for lecture presentations.
 - Guided students through the structure of empirical papers.
 - Graded exams and provided feedback on students' answers.

Scholarships

Full scholarship granted by Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK)	Sep 2020 – Jan 2023
BIDEB 2232 International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers Programme	
Full tuition scholarship granted by Sabancı University	Sep 2016 – June 2020
Full tuition scholarship granted by MEF University	Sep 2016 – June 2020

Awards

Yale Wu Tsai Institute Travel Award for attending CNS 2026 (500\$) Link:

<https://www.cogneurosociety.org/past-award-winners/>

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, R, Python

Toolboxes: Psychtoolbox, EEGLAB, ERPLAB, Fieldtrip

Data acquisition: EEG

References

Prof. Dr. Elkan Akyürek

PhD Supervisor

University of Groningen

e.g.akyurek@rug.nl

Dr. Wouter Kruijne

PhD Supervisor

University of Groningen

w.kruijne@rug.nl

PD. Dr. Daniel Schneider

Collaborator/Research Visit

Leibniz Research Centre for Working Environment and Human Factors

schneiderd@ifado.de

Asst. Prof. Dr. Eren Günseli

Master's Degree Supervisor

Sabancı University

eren.gunseli@sabanciuniv.edu